

HIVE CONSULT

Digital Forensics Laboratory, Accra



DIGITAL FORENSIC INVESTIGATION REPORT

Operation “Dirty Ledger” — Financial Fraud & Money Laundering Investigation

Field	Detail
Case Reference	DIGITAL-FORENSICS-CTF-LAB / Dirty Ledger - Financial Fraud Case
Primary Suspect	Paul Addo
Front Company (Search Site)	Delta Ventures Ltd
Date of Seizure	15 March 2025
Investigating Agency	Ghana Financial Intelligence Centre (FIC)

Field	Detail
Forensic Laboratory	HIVE CONSULT Digital Forensics Laboratory, Accra
Evidence Item	Laptop computer (E01 forensic image), Autopsy analysis
Report Status	Draft — for internal review

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Executive Summary

This report documents the findings of a digital forensic examination conducted on a laptop computer seized on 15 March 2025 from the premises of Delta Ventures Ltd, pursuant to a search and seizure order issued in connection with a coordinated money laundering investigation by the Ghana Financial Intelligence Centre (FIC). The laptop, belonging to the primary suspect Paul Addo, was forensically acquired as an E01 disk image and examined using Autopsy at HIVE CONSULT Digital Forensics Laboratory, Accra.

The examination recovered extensive evidence of a structured money laundering operation spanning at least two financial cycles (2024 and Q1 2025), involving multiple front companies, a network of named associates with defined operational roles, falsified invoicing, structured cash deposits designed to evade Financial Intelligence Centre reporting thresholds, international wire transfers to Dubai (UAE) and Limassol (Cyprus), and direct corruption of a Senior Compliance Officer at the FIC to suppress a regulatory query.

Evidence was recovered across WhatsApp communications, financial spreadsheets, falsified invoices, email correspondence, ProtonMail encrypted communications, Dropbox cloud-sync artifacts, browser search history, and saved browser credentials. The evidence is highly cross-corroborated: key figures (notably the Q1 2025 target of GH¢500,000 and actual processed amount of GH¢487,000, and the offshore total of USD 105,000) appear consistently across at least three independent artifact categories.

Key findings include:

- A hierarchical criminal network with a concealed superior (“Boss”) directing operations via Proton Mail, and at least five named subordinates with defined roles (financial processing, offshore transfers, cash collection, and intermediary bribery delivery).
- Three front companies — Delta Ventures Ltd, Gyimah Construction & Supplies, and West Coast Logistics Ltd — used to issue 14 falsified invoices totalling GH¢677,000 in Q1 2025 alone.
- Structured (“smurfed”) cash deposits kept below GH¢9,500 per transaction, a figure traced directly to a browser search for the FIC reporting threshold.
- Two completed international wire transfers totalling USD 105,000 to Dubai and Cyprus, disguised as “consultancy” and “software licensing” fees.
- Direct, documented bribery of a named FIC Senior Compliance Officer (GH¢5,000 per quarter) resulting in the withdrawal of regulatory query TRK-2025-0118.
- Evidence of attempted (and largely unsuccessful) anti-forensic activity, including instructions to delete WhatsApp messages, a browser search for evidence-wiping software, and an order to destroy a physical receipt linking cash collections to Delta Ventures Ltd.
- Evidence of a prior-year (2024) iteration of the same scheme, indicating an ongoing, recurring operation rather than an isolated incident.

The findings below are organised according to the 23 investigation tasks set out in the case briefing, across six sections: Image Integrity & Filesystem (A), WhatsApp Evidence (B), Financial Documents (C), Email & Cloud Evidence (D), Browser & Anti-Forensics (E), and Timeline & Analysis (F).

Section A: Image Integrity & Filesystem

Task 1: Verify Image Integrity

The E01 forensic image was acquired and verified prior to analysis in accordance with standard forensic procedure. Hash verification (MD5/SHA-1) should be performed on the acquired image and compared against the value recorded at the time of acquisition to confirm that no alteration occurred between seizure and examination.

Note: hash values were not directly captured in the screenshots reviewed during this examination. It is recommended that the original acquisition hash log produced by the imaging tool (e.g., FTK Imager, Guymager) be appended to this report as Appendix A to formally document chain-of-custody integrity verification.

The screenshot displays the AccessData FTK Imager 4.7.1.2 interface. The 'Properties' pane on the left shows the following details:

- Evidence Source Path: E:\Forensic.x\Cases CTF\C\HC-GH-
- Evidence Type: Forensic Disk Image
- Disk**
 - Verification Hashes**
 - MD5 verification hash: 7f3a2604f3ea91f0a23f93efe146a
 - Drive Geometry**
 - Bytes per Sector: 512
 - Sector Count: 10,182,568
 - Image**
 - Image Type: E01
 - Case number: HC-GH-2025-FF-0047
 - Evidence number: HIVE CONSULT Digital Forensics
 - Examiner: Nana Sei Anyemedu
 - Notes: Created by Nana Sei Anyemedu
 - Acquired on OS: Linux
 - Acquired using: 20140814
 - Acquire date: 6/12/2026 10:51:36 AM
 - System date: 6/12/2026 10:51:36 AM
 - Unique description: Operation Dirty Ledger □ Financi

The 'File List' pane on the right shows a hex dump of the image data, starting with the NTFS boot sector signature 'eR-NTFS'.

Name	Size	Type	Date Modified
Hex Dump Data (Address 00000000 to 000000110)			

Task 2: Filesystem Identification

The disk image was processed in Autopsy and mounted successfully, with Autopsy's standard module set (Data Artifacts, Analysis Results, File Metadata, OS Account) populating correctly — consistent with an NTFS filesystem, the default for a Windows-based laptop. User profile artifacts were located under the standard Windows path structure C:\Users\paddo\..., confirming a Windows operating system with a local user account associated with the username “paddo” (Paul Addo).

Dirty Ledger - Autopsy 4.22.1

Case View Tools Window Help

+ Add Data Source Images/Videos Communications Geolocation Timeline Discovery Generate Report Close Case

Listing
/img_HC-GH-2025-FF-0047_PADD0_LAPTOP.E01

Table Thumbnail Summary

Name	S	C	O	Modified Time	Change 1
\$Extend				2026-06-12 10:50:31 UTC	2026-06-
\$Recycle.Bin				2026-06-12 10:50:45 UTC	2026-06-
\$Unalloc				0000-00-00 00:00:00	0000-00-
[current folder]				2026-06-12 10:50:45 UTC	2026-06-
Google Drive				2026-06-12 10:50:45 UTC	2026-06-
Users				2026-06-12 10:50:32 UTC	2026-06-
Windows				2026-06-12 10:50:45 UTC	2026-06-
\$AttrDef			3	2026-06-12 10:50:31 UTC	2026-06-
\$BadClus				2026-06-12 10:50:31 UTC	2026-06-
\$BadClus:\$Bad				2026-06-12 10:50:31 UTC	2026-06-
\$Bitmap			0	2026-06-12 10:50:31 UTC	2026-06-
\$Boot			0	2026-06-12 10:50:31 UTC	2026-06-
\$LogFile			0	2026-06-12 10:50:31 UTC	2026-06-
\$MFT			0	0000-00-00 00:00:00	0000-00-

Data Sources

- HC-GH-2025-FF-0047_PADD0_LAPTOP.E01_1 Host
- HC-GH-2025-FF-0047_PADD0_LAPTOP.E01_296 Host
- HC-GH-2025-FF-0047_PADD0_LAPTOP.E01
 - \$OrphanFiles (8)
 - \$Extend (5)
 - \$Recycle.Bin (3)
 - \$Unalloc (1)
 - Google Drive (3)
 - Users (3)
 - Windows (3)

File Views

- File Types
- Deleted Files
- MB File Size

Data Artifacts

- Communication Accounts (18)
- E-Mail Messages (9)
- Metadata (18)
- Recycle Bin (1)

Analysis Results

- Keyword Hits (116)

Task 3: File Count

A full file count was not directly captured during this examination; this figure is typically obtained from the Autopsy case summary / ingest module results (File Metadata view, total file count). It is recommended that the total allocated and unallocated file counts be extracted from the Autopsy “File Views” summary and recorded here, including a breakdown of deleted/unallocated files identified (cross-reference Task 22, which identified at least 3 deleted Dropbox-synced files in the /OLD/ directory).

Section B: WhatsApp Evidence

Task 4: Locate WhatsApp Database

The WhatsApp message database (msgstore.db, SQLite format) was located on the suspect's device partition at the standard WhatsApp installation path. The “messages” table was extracted via Autopsy's Data Artifacts module, yielding 55 entries (identifiers MSG001–MSG055) spanning the period 24 December 2024 to 10 March 2025 — a continuous communications record immediately preceding the 15 March 2025 seizure.

msgstore.db	0	2026-06-12 10:50:32 UTC	2026-06-12 10:50:32 UTC	2026-06-12 10:50:32 UTC	2026-06-12 10:50:32 UTC	36864	Allocated	Allocated
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Hex	Text	Application	File Metadata	OS Account	Data Artifacts	Analysis Results	Context	Annotations	Other Occurrences
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Table	messages	55 entries	Page 1 of 1	Export to CSV
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_id	key_remote_jid	key_from...	key_id	status	data	timestamp	med
28	233284281931@s.whatsapp.net	1	MSG028	1	1736931600	Collected. Where do I drop?	
29	233284281931@s.whatsapp.net	0	MSG029	1	1736931900	Accra Central. Mary has the address. Don't use your name.	
30	233284281931@s.whatsapp.net	1	MSG030	1	1736953200	Dropped. They gave me a receipt under Delta Ventures Ltd.	
31	233284281931@s.whatsapp.net	0	MSG031	1	1736953800	Good. Burn the receipt.	
32	233284281931@s.whatsapp.net	1	MSG032	1	1738749600	Paul what is this Police Control on the Accra-Kumasi road about?	
33	233284281931@s.whatsapp.net	0	MSG033	1	1738750080	Not our issue. Move on a different day. Tell Mary to pause the Kumasi run.	
34	233284281931@s.whatsapp.net	1	MSG034	1	1739174400	Kumasi Stanbic done. GH¢55,000. Kofi took the bag.	
35	233284281931@s.whatsapp.net	0	MSG035	1	1739175000	Was he alone?	
36	233284281931@s.whatsapp.net	1	MSG036	1	1739175180	Yes. Back room as usual.	
37	233284281931@s.whatsapp.net	0	MSG037	1	1741327200	Cape Coast this week Philip. GH¢40,000. Same process.	

Task 5: Suspect Communication Network

Analysis of the key_remote_jid field identified four distinct communication channels involving the suspect:

Contact / Group JID	Identity (Inferred)	Role
233283913821@s.whatsapp.net	Nancy	Microfinance-side payment processing
233287462810@s.whatsapp.net	Mary	Offshore transfer handler (Dubai / Cyprus)
233284281931@s.whatsapp.net	Philip	Cash courier / collector
233283913821-1620000000@g.us	“Team” group chat	Operational command channel, includes “Boss”

The presence of a group chat with the @g.us suffix confirms a hierarchical structure above Paul Addo, with a concealed superior (“Boss”) receiving periodic financial performance summaries.

Databases (12)

- Documents
- Executable
- By MIME Type
- Deleted Files
- File Size
- ta Artifacts
- Communication Accounts (18)
- E-Mail Messages (9)
- Metadata (18)
- Recycle Bin (1)
- alysis Results
- Keyword Hits (116)
- Accounts
- js
- ore
- ports

msgstore.db

0

2026-06-12 10:50:32 UTC

2026-06-12 10:50:32 UTC

Hex

Text

Application

File Metadata

OS Account

Data Artifacts

Analysis Results

Context

Annotati

Table

chat_list

5 entries

Page 1 of 1

Export to CSV

_id	key_remote_jid	message...	subject	creation	sort_timest...
1	233283913821@s.whatsapp.net		Nancy Aggrey	1730419200	1741564800
2	233287462810@s.whatsapp.net		Mary Gyasi	1730419200	1741564800
3	233284281931@s.whatsapp.net		Philip Adanse	1730419200	1741564800
4	233281738191@s.whatsapp.net		Boss Man	1730419200	1741564800
5	233283913821-1620000000@g.us		DL Syndicate	1730419200	1741564800

Task 6: Role Assignments

Based on message content across the recovered communications, the following roles within the network were established:

Individual	Role
Paul Addo (suspect)	Central coordinator; primary point of contact for all subordinates and the “Boss”
Nancy	Processes payments through microfinance institutions (e.g., Accra Microfinance) using structured deposit references
Mary	Manages offshore fund transfers (Dubai / Cyprus); also coordinates FIC bribery logistics with Paul
Philip	Physical cash collection/courier across multiple regions; sources falsified invoices; delivers FIC bribe payments
Kofi	Subordinate courier; collected cash in Kumasi
“Kweku”	Intermediary who passes cash bribes from Philip to the FIC contact
“Boss”	Concealed superior; sets quarterly targets and strategic direction via the group chat and Proton Mail

Hex	Text	Application	File Metadata	OS Account	Data Artifacts	Analysis Results	Context	Annotations	Other Occurrences
Table: messages 55 entries Page 1 of 1 Export to CSV									
_id	key_remote_jid	key_from...	key_id	status	data	timestamp	media_url		
1	233283913821@s.whatsapp.net	0	MSG001	1	1736068500	Nancy the invoice for GH¢85,000 is ready. Send to the usual Koforidua account.			
2	233283913821@s.whatsapp.net	1	MSG002	1	1736068920	Received. I'll process through Accra Microfinance today. Which reference?			
3	233283913821@s.whatsapp.net	0	MSG003	1	1736069460	Use REF-AML-2025-0041. Split: GH¢50k + GH¢35k to different branches.			
4	233283913821@s.whatsapp.net	1	MSG004	1	1736071500	Done. Confirmation slips uploading to Drive now.			
5	233283913821@s.whatsapp.net	0	MSG005	1	1736071920	Perfect. Delete these messages after reading.			
6	233283913821@s.whatsapp.net	1	MSG006	1	1736690400	Paul the Kumasi batch cleared. GH¢120,000 split across 4 accounts as planned.			
7	233283913821@s.whatsapp.net	0	MSG007	1	1736690880	Excellent. Philip knows? He needs to collect from Western side this week.			
8	233283913821@s.whatsapp.net	1	MSG008	1	1736691300	He knows. Mary is handling the offshore part.			
9	233283913821@s.whatsapp.net	0	MSG009	1	1738572300	New invoice attached. GH¢200,000. Goes through the construction company front.			
10	233283913821@s.whatsapp.net	0	MSG010	1	1738572360	invoice_Feb2025.pdf			
11	233283913821@s.whatsapp.net	1	MSG011	1	1740049200	Paul I used the new account for the Stanbic batch. Ref: AMF-STB-200225.			
12	233283913821@s.whatsapp.net	0	MSG012	1	1740049800	Good. Don't link it to the February invoice. Use the Gyimah name.			
13	233283913821@s.whatsapp.net	1	MSG013	1	1740821400	Q1 total from my side: GH¢325,000. All cleared. No exceptions raised.			
14	233283913821@s.whatsapp.net	0	MSG014	1	1740822000	Perfect. Awaiting Mary's offshore confirmation then we report to Boss.			
15	233287462810@s.whatsapp.net	0	MSG015	1	1736334000	Mary has the Dubai transfer gone through?			
16	233287462810@s.whatsapp.net	1	MSG016	1	1736335320	Yes. USD 45,000 landed in the Al Maktoum account. No flags.			
17	233287462810@s.whatsapp.net	0	MSG017	1	1736335800	Good. Next tranche is USD 60k. Same route.			
18	233287462810@s.whatsapp.net	1	MSG018	1	1736336700	Need new documentation for that amount. Can you get Gyimah to prepare falsified invoices?			
19	233287462810@s.whatsapp.net	0	MSG019	1	1736337720	Already done. Check the Dropbox folder EXPORTS_2025.			
20	233287462810@s.whatsapp.net	1	MSG020	1	1737388800	Paul the FIC almost asked questions about the Takoradi transactions.			
21	233287462810@s.whatsapp.net	0	MSG021	1	1737389400	Don't worry. I've arranged for the report to be amended. Philip handled it.			
22	233287462810@s.whatsapp.net	1	MSG022	1	1739523600	Second tranche ready. ledger_offshore_Q1.xlsx is in Drive.			
23	233287462810@s.whatsapp.net	0	MSG023	1	1739524200	Confirmed. Cyprus route or Dubai this time?			

Task 7: Cash Collection Orders

The following explicit cash collection instructions were identified in Philip's communication thread:

Approx. Date	Location	Amount	Instruction
15 Jan 2025	Tarkwa branch	GH¢75,000	Collect cash
15 Jan 2025	Accra Central	—	Drop-off via address provided by Mary; instructed not to use own name
10 Feb 2025	Kumasi (Stanbic)	GH¢55,000	Collected by Kofi
7 Mar 2025	Cape Coast	GH¢40,000	Scheduled for Wednesday; instructed to use coast road to avoid checkpoints

This pattern establishes a recurring, multi-regional cash courier operation consistent with deliberate structuring of cash deposits to remain below regulatory reporting thresholds (see Task 21, Stage 1 — Placement).

Task 8: Evidence Destruction Intent

Two explicit instances of evidence destruction instructions were identified within the WhatsApp dataset:

- 8 January 2025 (MSG005): “Perfect. Delete these messages after reading.” — issued immediately following discussion of split-deposit instructions under reference REF-AML-2025-0041.
- 15 January 2025 (MSG031): “Good. Burn the receipt.” — issued in direct response to Philip's report (MSG030) that a cash drop-off receipt had been issued under the name “Delta Ventures Ltd.”

These two messages constitute strong evidence of consciousness of guilt and active obstruction. MSG031 in particular directly links Delta Ventures Ltd — the company at the seized premises — to a deliberately destroyed item of physical evidence, corroborating the legitimacy and relevance of the search and seizure warrant. The instruction in MSG005 was not in fact carried out in full: all 55 messages remained recoverable in the msgstore.db (see Task 22).

TODO_DELETE_THESE.txt		0	2026-06-12 10:50:32 UTC	2026-06-12 10:50:32 UTC	2026-06-12 10:50:32 UTC	2026-06-12 10:50:32 UTC	434	Allocated
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Hex

Text

Application

File Metadata

OS Account

Data Artifacts

Analysis Results

Context

Annotations

Other Occurrences

Strings

Extracted Text

Translation

Page: 1 of 1 Page

←

→

Matches on page: - of - Match

←

→

100%

🗨

🔍

Reset

Text Source: File Text

IMPORTANT — DELETE BEFORE END OF MARCH

- Shred physical ledgers (Nancy has them)
- Delete Dropbox OLD folder
- Clear Chrome history (use CCleaner)
- Tell Philip to lose the Delta Ventures card
- Move Sheets to new Google account before April
- FIC follow-up — check with contact if query is closed
- Mary: confirm Cyprus transfer done before Q2 starts

Created by Nana Sei Anyemedu | Property of HIVE CONSULT | HC-GH-2025-FF-0047

Section C: Financial Documents

Task 9: Master Transaction Ledger

Geolocation Timeline Discovery Generate Report Close Case									
Listing									
/img_HC-GH-2025-FF-0047_PADD0_LAPTOP.E01/Users/paddo/AppData/Local/Dropbox									
Table Thumbnail Summary									
Name	S	C	O	Modified Time	Change Time	Access Time	Created Time	Size	Flags(Dir)
[current folder]				2026-06-12 10:50:32 UTC	2026-06-12 10:50:32 UTC	2026-06-12 10:50:32 UTC	2026-06-12 10:50:32 UTC	152	Allocated
[parent folder]				2026-06-12 10:50:32 UTC	2026-06-12 10:50:32 UTC	2026-06-12 10:50:32 UTC	2026-06-12 10:50:32 UTC	336	Allocated
config.db			0	2026-06-12 10:50:32 UTC	2026-06-12 10:50:32 UTC	2026-06-12 10:50:32 UTC	2026-06-12 10:50:32 UTC	28672	Allocated
Hex Text Application File Metadata OS Account Data Artifacts Analysis Results Context Annotations Other Occurrences									
Table file_journal 15 entries Page 1 of 1 Export to CSV									
id	server_path	local_path		modified_ti...	size	is_deletec			
1	/EXPORTS_2025/falsified_invoices_Q1.zip	C:\Users\paddo\Dropbox\EXPORTS_2025\falsified_invoices_Q1.zip		1740045600	2048000	0			
2	/EXPORTS_2025/invoice_Feb2025.pdf	C:\Users\paddo\Dropbox\EXPORTS_2025\invoice_Feb2025.pdf		1738572600	188000	0			
3	/EXPORTS_2025/invoice_Jan2025.pdf	C:\Users\paddo\Dropbox\EXPORTS_2025\invoice_Jan2025.pdf		1736070300	175000	0			
4	/EXPORTS_2025/ledger_offshore_Q1.xlsx	C:\Users\paddo\Dropbox\EXPORTS_2025\ledger_offshore_Q1.xlsx		1739523900	98000	0			
5	/EXPORTS_2025/Delta_Ventures_Registration.pdf	C:\Users\paddo\Dropbox\EXPORTS_2025\Delta_Ventures_Registration.pdf		1733839200	320000	0			
6	/EXPORTS_2025/Accra_Micro_Batch_Jan.csv	C:\Users\paddo\Dropbox\EXPORTS_2025\Accra_Micro_Batch_Jan.csv		1736692200	55000	0			
7	/EXPORTS_2025/account_routing_offshore.txt	C:\Users\paddo\Dropbox\EXPORTS_2025\account_routing_offshore.txt		1736337900	4200	0			
8	/EXPORTS_2025/collection_schedule_Feb.xlsx	C:\Users\paddo\Dropbox\EXPORTS_2025\collection_schedule_Feb.xlsx		1738404000	72000	0			
9	/EXPORTS_2025/Q2_planning_draft.docx	C:\Users\paddo\Dropbox\EXPORTS_2025\Q2_planning_draft.docx		1741629600	88000	0			
10	/EXPORTS_2025/Boss_directives_Q1.txt	C:\Users\paddo\Dropbox\EXPORTS_2025\Boss_directives_Q1.txt		1735887600	3100	0			
11	/EXPORTS_2025/FIC_contact_details.txt	C:\Users\paddo\Dropbox\EXPORTS_2025\FIC_contact_details.txt		1737327600	1800	0			
12	/EXPORTS_2025/invoice_template_blank.docx	C:\Users\paddo\Dropbox\EXPORTS_2025\invoice_template_blank.docx		1734256800	65000	0			
13	/OLD/ledger_2024_Q3.xlsx	C:\Users\paddo\Dropbox\OLD\ledger_2024_Q3.xlsx		1728144000	88000	1			
14	/OLD/contacts_dirty.txt	C:\Users\paddo\Dropbox\OLD\contacts_dirty.txt		1730458800	3200	1			
15	/OLD/offshore_routing_2024.txt	C:\Users\paddo\Dropbox\OLD\offshore_routing_2024.txt		1725976800	2800	1			

The file `ledger_offshore_Q1.xlsx` was recovered from the Dropbox-synced folder `C:\Users\paddo\Dropbox\EXPORTS_2025\`. The spreadsheet is internally referenced under case identifier `HC-GH-2025-FF-0047` and records three international wire transfers for Q1 2025, totalling USD 105,000 (cleared transactions) against a GHS equivalent figure of 1,365,000.

This ledger directly corroborates figures referenced independently in WhatsApp communications (MSG016, MSG024, MSG026) and in the Q1 Summary email sent via ProtonMail (PM-2025-0001), providing strong cross-source verification.

Task 10: Offshore Routing

Date	TXN Reference	Beneficiary	Bank / Country	Amount (USD)	Routing Description	Status
08 Jan 2025	TXN-INTL-2025-00882	Al Maktoum Investment Holdings LLC	Emirates NBD, UAE	45,000	“Consultancy Services Q4 2024”	CLEARED

Date	TXN Reference	Beneficiary	Bank / Country	Amount (USD)	Routing Description	Status
18 Jan 2025	TXN-INTL-2025-00943	Limassol Trade & Advisory Ltd	Hellenic Bank, Cyprus	60,000	“Software License Fees Q4 2024”	CLEARED
14 Feb 2025	TXN-INTL-2025-(pending)	Limassol Trade & Advisory Ltd	Hellenic Bank, Cyprus	(not recorded)	“Q1 2025 Adjustment”	IN_PROGRESS

The two completed transfers (USD 45,000 to Dubai and USD 60,000 to Cyprus) total USD 105,000, matching the Q1 offshore figure reported to “Boss” (PM-2025-0001: “offshore USD 105k. Dubai and Cyprus confirmed.”). A third transaction to the same Cyprus beneficiary was recorded as IN_PROGRESS at the time of seizure, with no amount populated in the ledger — however, the GHS_Equivalent total column (1,365,000) is consistent with only the two cleared transactions, suggesting the third transaction's value field may be incomplete or pending entry. This third transaction should be flagged for urgent follow-up with Cypriot authorities, as it may represent funds still in transit or recoverable.

Full wire transfer confirmations (Task 13) provide the supporting banking details: Dubai account AE070331234567890123456 (Al Maktoum Investment Holdings LLC) and Cyprus IBAN CY17002001280000001200527600 (Limassol Trade & Advisory Ltd).

Task 11: Falsified Invoices

An email dated 20 February 2025 from mary.gyasi.finance@gmail.com to paul.addo.accragh@gmail.com (subject: “RE: EXPORTS_2025 — Docs Ready”) confirms the preparation of a complete set of falsified invoices for Q1 2025:

Front Company	Invoice Count	Total Value (GH¢)
Delta Ventures Ltd	6	312,000
Gyimah Construction & Supplies	5	218,000
West Coast Logistics Ltd	3	147,000
TOTAL	14	677,000

The complete set was archived as Dropbox/EXPORTS_2025/falsified_invoices_Q1.zip, password-protected, with the email noting the password was “same as before” — indicating reuse of security practices from a prior laundering cycle. Individual invoice files invoice_Jan2025.pdf and invoice_Feb2025.pdf were also recovered from the same folder; the February invoice (GH¢200,000) is directly referenced in WhatsApp message MSG010 as routing “through the construction company front”, almost certainly Gyimah Construction & Supplies.

This directly fulfils the request made in MSG019 (“Can you get Gyimah to prepare falsified invoices?”), establishing a clear evidential chain from instruction to delivery.

Task 12: Money Laundering Strategy

The overarching laundering strategy is documented most explicitly in Boss_directives_Q1.txt (recovered from Dropbox/EXPORTS_2025/), received via ProtonMail on 3 January 2025 (message PM-2025-0005). The directive sets out seven operational rules:

3. Target: GH¢500,000 “clean” by 31 March 2025.

4. No single transaction to exceed GH¢9,500 (structuring below the GH¢10,000 FIC reporting threshold).
5. Use existing front companies only: Delta Ventures, Gyimah, West Coast.
6. Offshore routing priority: Dubai first, Cyprus for overflow.
7. FIC budget: GH¢5,000 per quarter, arranged via cash through Philip.
8. No phone calls regarding amounts — WhatsApp or Proton Mail only.
9. Weekly status updates via Proton Mail.

This directive was marked “DO NOT PRINT. DELETE AFTER MEMORISING” but was recovered intact, representing a significant operational security failure on the part of the network and a key piece of strategic evidence. Every operational element observed elsewhere in this investigation — the GH¢9,500 structuring cap, the three named front companies, the Dubai/Cyprus routing order, and the FIC bribery arrangement — traces directly back to this single document, which is therefore considered the central strategic exhibit of this case.

Section D: Email & Cloud Evidence

Task 13: Wire Transfer Confirmation

Two wire transfer confirmation emails were recovered, both sent from notifications@ecowasbank-alerts.net to paul.addo.accragh@gmail.com:

Field	Wire 1 (UAE)	Wire 2 (Cyprus)
Reference	TXN-INTL-2025-00882	TXN-INTL-2025-00943
Amount	USD 45,000.00	USD 60,000.00
Beneficiary	Al Maktoum Investment Holdings LLC	Limassol Trade & Advisory Ltd
Destination	Dubai, UAE — Account AE070331234567890123456	Cyprus — IBAN CY17002001280000001200527600
Description	Consultancy Services Q4 2024	Software License Fees Q4 2024
Status	COMPLETED	COMPLETED

The “Description” fields represent the falsified commercial pretexts used to disguise the true purpose of the funds, consistent with the use of “existing fronts only” directed in Boss_directives_Q1.txt. Both descriptions reference “Q4 2024” despite the transfers occurring in January 2025, a discrepancy that may indicate reuse of documentation templates from the prior year’s iteration of the scheme (see Task 22, /OLD/ folder).

The sender domain “ecowasbank-alerts.net” does not correspond to a recognised major Ghanaian or West African banking institution (cf. Ecobank, GCB Bank, Stanbic) and should be independently verified. If this domain is found to be unaffiliated with a regulated financial institution, it may indicate the use of an unregulated or shell payment intermediary, which would itself constitute additional evidence relevant to the investigation.

The account/IBAN details identified above should be forwarded to the relevant national Financial Intelligence Units (UAE FIU and Cyprus MOKAS) to support asset tracing and potential freeze requests.

Task 14: FIC Obstruction

The file FIC_contact_details.txt, recovered from Dropbox/EXPORTS_2025/, provides direct documentary evidence of the corruption of a Financial Intelligence Centre official:

- Position: Senior Compliance Officer (name redacted in the recovered file; described as “known to Paul only”)
- Cost: GH¢5,000 per quarter, cash only
- Payment chain: Philip delivers cash to an intermediary identified only as “Kweku”, who passes the payment to the FIC contact
- Documented outcome: “Last payment 2025-01-19 (Q1 FIC query TRK-2025-0118 withdrawn)”

This is independently corroborated by ProtonMail message PM-2025-0003 (19 January 2025, paddo.secure@proton.me to mary.offshore@proton.me): “FIC query TRK-2025-0118 will be withdrawn. Cost: GHS 5,000 this quarter. Arrange via Accra...”, and by Mary’s reply (PM-2025-0004) confirming the arrangement and querying delivery method. This exchange also corresponds to WhatsApp messages MSG020–MSG021, in which Paul informs the group that

“the FIC almost asked questions about the Takoradi transactions” and that “the report [has been] amended.”

Reference TRK-2025-0118 is a specific, traceable internal FIC case/query identifier and should be cross-referenced against the FIC's own internal records as a priority action item. The individual identified only as “Kweku” represents an unidentified person of interest requiring further investigation.

Task 15: Dropbox File Journal

The Dropbox file_journal table (15 entries) was recovered, comprising 12 active files within /EXPORTS_2025/ and 3 deleted files (is_deleted = 1) within a folder named /OLD/. The active folder contents are summarised below:

File	Significance
falsified_invoices_Q1.zip	Falsified invoice archive (Task 11)
ledger_offshore_Q1.xlsx	Master offshore transaction ledger (Tasks 9–10)
invoice_Jan2025.pdf / invoice_Feb2025.pdf	Individual falsified invoices (Task 11)
Delta_Ventures_Registration.pdf	Front company incorporation document — formal paper trail for Delta Ventures Ltd
Accra_Micro_Batch_Jan.csv	Corresponds to microfinance split-deposit batch (MSG002/004)
account_routing_offshore.txt	Account/routing details for offshore transfers
collection_schedule_Feb.xlsx	Cash collection schedule (Task 7)
FIC_contact_details.txt	FIC bribery arrangement (Task 14)
Boss_directives_Q1.txt	Operational strategy document (Task 12)
Q2_planning_draft.docx	Forward-looking Q2 expansion plans (new Kumasi front, AMF channel expansion)
invoice_template_blank.docx	Blank invoice template — demonstrates the invoices were internally fabricated rather than genuinely issued

The deleted /OLD/ folder contained ledger_2024_Q3.xlsx, contacts_dirty.txt, and offshore_routing_2024.txt — evidence of a prior-year iteration of the same scheme (see Task 22 and Task 21 supporting analysis).

Task 16: ProtonMail Evidence

Five encrypted ProtonMail messages (is_encrypted = 1) were recovered for the account paddo.secure@proton.me — a dedicated “clean” alias used exclusively for communication with the network's concealed superior and with Mary's offshore-dedicated alias.

ID	Date	From → To	Summary
PM-2025-0005	03 Jan 2025	bigdirector.anon → paddo.secure	Boss Directive — Q1 target GH¢500,000, GH¢9,500 cap, fronts, offshore routing, OPSEC rules (= Boss_directives_Q1.txt)
PM-2025-0003	19 Jan 2025	paddo.secure → mary.offshore	FIC query TRK-2025-0118 to be withdrawn for GH¢5,000 this quarter

ID	Date	From → To	Summary
PM-2025-0004	20 Jan 2025	mary.offshore → paddo.secure	Confirms FIC payment arrangement; asks delivery method (Philip cash vs. bank transfer)
PM-2025-0001	28 Feb 2025	paddo.secure → bigdirector.anon	Q1 Summary (Confidential): GH¢487k processed; offshore USD 105k (Dubai + Cyprus); no alerts
PM-2025-0002	01 Mar 2025	bigdirector.anon → paddo.secure	Q2 Expansion: register new front in Kumasi by April; expand AMF channel

Key findings from this artifact category:

- A previously unseen alias, mary.offshore@proton.me, is identified — corroborating Mary's expanded role in FIC bribery logistics, not solely offshore transfers.
- The Boss–Paul command channel (bigdirector.anon@proton.me ↔ paddo.secure@proton.me) is now corroborated across three independent artifact types: the WhatsApp group chat, Boss_directives_Q1.txt, and this ProtonMail export.
- The Q1 figures (GH¢487,000 / USD 105,000) appear consistently in WhatsApp (MSG043), the offshore ledger (Task 9), and this email — a strong evidentiary triangulation.
- TRK-2025-0118 is now documented in two independent artifact types (text file and email) with a matching date (19 January 2025), strengthening the FIC corruption finding.

Section E: Browser & Anti-Forensics

Task 17: Incriminating Searches

The screenshot shows a file explorer view of the Chrome User Data directory. The left pane displays the file structure, including folders like 'Users (3)', 'paddo (9)', 'AppData (4)', 'Local (5)', 'Dropbox (3)', 'Google (3)', 'Chrome (3)', 'User Data (3)', 'Default (5)', 'Temp (5)', 'Roaming (7)', 'Desktop (3)', 'Documents (11)', 'Downloads (10)', 'Pictures (11)', 'Videos (7)', and 'Windows (3)'. The right pane shows a table of recovered keyword search terms.

keyword_id	url_id	lower_term	term
1	14	how to move money offshore ghana	how to move money offshore ghana
1	15	anti money laundering detection ghana	anti money laundering detection ghana
1	16	fic reporting threshold ghana 2024	FIC reporting threshold Ghana 2024
1	17	falsify invoice ghana company	falsify invoice Ghana company
1	21	how to delete whatsapp messages permanently	how to delete whatsapp messages permanently
1	22	ccleaner delete browser history permanently	CCleaner delete browser history permanently
1	23	swift wire transfer no trace ghana	SWIFT wire transfer no trace ghana
1	30	police checkpoint accra kumasi highway	police checkpoint accra kumasi highway

Eight entries were recovered from the Chrome keyword_search_terms table. Six relate to operational planning and evasion research:

Search Term	Relevance
how to move money offshore ghana	Pre-planning for offshore routing (Task 10)
anti money laundering detection ghana	Research into AML detection mechanisms
FIC reporting threshold Ghana 2024	Directly explains the GH¢9,500 structuring cap in Boss_directives_Q1.txt
falsify invoice Ghana company	Pre-planning for the falsified invoice scheme (Task 11)
SWIFT wire transfer no trace ghana	Pre-planning for untraceable international wires
police checkpoint Accra Kumasi highway	Matches WhatsApp MSG032/033 — searched immediately before rerouting a Kumasi cash collection

Task 18: Anti-Forensic Evidence

The remaining two search entries demonstrate direct anti-forensic intent:

Search Term	Significance
how to delete whatsapp messages permanently	Corresponds to MSG005 (“Delete these messages after reading”)
CCleaner delete browser history permanently	Suspect attempted to wipe his own browser history using a third-party tool

These searches, combined with the instruction to “burn the receipt” (Task 8) and the GH¢5,000/quarter payment to suppress the FIC query (Task 14), establish a consistent pattern of consciousness of guilt and active obstruction across digital and physical evidence categories. Notably, the search query relating to CCleaner itself survived within the browser's keyword_search_terms table, despite being a tool intended to erase such records — the attempted anti-forensic action did not achieve its purpose.

Task 19: Saved Credentials

Seven credential records were recovered from Chrome's Login Data SQLite database (table: logins). Password values were stored as encrypted BLOBs and were not recoverable without the associated Windows DPAPI/OS keychain key; however, the associated metadata is highly significant.

Site	Username	Notes
mail.google.com	paul.addo.accragh@gmail.com	Primary day-to-day operational email
dropbox.com/login	paul.addo.ventures@gmail.com	Distinct alias used specifically for Dropbox / EXPORTS_2025
accramicrofinance.com	p.addo	Direct personal/admin login to the microfinance institution used for laundering deposits
deltaventuresltd.business	admin	Front company website — general administrative access
web.facebook.com	paul.addo.gh	Personal/business social media
transferwise.com (Wise)	paul.addo.ventures@gmail.com	Previously undocumented money transfer channel — new lead
proton.me	paddo.secure@proton.me	Confirms the Boss-facing ProtonMail alias (Task 16)
deltaventuresltd.business/admin	paddo_admin	Separate, personal admin-level credential for the front company backend

This artifact reveals at least three distinct identity tiers used by the suspect: a public/day-to-day Gmail account (paul.addo.accragh@gmail.com), a laundering-operations-specific Gmail account (paul.addo.ventures@gmail.com, used for Dropbox and Wise), and a Boss-facing ProtonMail alias (paddo.secure@proton.me).

Two findings are of particular investigative significance:

- Direct personal credentialed access to accramicrofinance.com indicates either an insider relationship with, or a controlled account at, that institution — beyond simply being a deposit beneficiary.
- A previously undocumented Wise (TransferWise) account registered to paul.addo.ventures@gmail.com represents an additional money transfer channel not referenced in any other recovered artifact, and should be prioritised for a data request/subpoena to Wise.

Section F: Timeline & Analysis

Task 20: Event Timeline

Date	Event	Source
24 Sep 2024	offshore_routing_2024.txt last modified (prior-year operation)	Dropbox journal (/OLD/)
24 Dec 2024	Nancy: GH¢85,000 invoice ready, to be sent to Koforidua account	WhatsApp MSG001
24 Dec 2024	Paul: split deposit GH¢50k + GH¢35k under REF-AML-2025-0041	WhatsApp MSG003–004
24 Dec 2024	Paul: “Delete these messages after reading”	WhatsApp MSG005
03 Jan 2025	Boss_directives_Q1.txt received via ProtonMail — Q1 strategy set out	PM-2025-0005 / Dropbox
05–07 Jan 2025	Searches: offshore movement, AML detection, FIC reporting threshold	Browser history
08 Jan 2025	Wire TXN-INTL-2025-00882: USD 45,000 to Al Maktoum Holdings, Dubai (“Consultancy Services”)	Email confirmation
12 Jan 2025	Mary confirms Dubai transfer landed, no flags; next tranche USD 60,000 planned	WhatsApp MSG015–017
13 Jan 2025	Philip asked to source falsified invoices via Gyimah for the large amount	WhatsApp MSG018–019
15 Jan 2025	Kumasi batch GH¢120,000 split across 4 accounts; roles assigned (Philip / Mary)	WhatsApp MSG006–008
15 Jan 2025	Philip ordered to collect GH¢75,000 from Tarkwa, drop at Accra Central without using his name	WhatsApp MSG027–029
15 Jan 2025	Receipt issued under Delta Ventures Ltd name; instruction to “burn the receipt”	WhatsApp MSG030–031
17 Jan 2025	Search: “falsify invoice ghana company”	Browser history
18 Jan 2025	Wire TXN-INTL-2025-00943: USD 60,000 to Limassol Trade & Advisory Ltd, Cyprus (“Software License Fees”)	Email confirmation
19 Jan 2025	FIC query TRK-2025-0118 ordered withdrawn for GH¢5,000 (FIC corruption)	PM-2025-0003 / FIC_contact_details.txt
19–20 Jan 2025	Second offshore tranche confirmed; ledger_offshore_Q1.xlsx uploaded to Dropbox	WhatsApp MSG022–024
20 Jan 2025	Mary confirms FIC payment arrangement, queries delivery method	PM-2025-0004
31 Jan 2025	Philip confirms collection of further cash, awaits drop-off location	WhatsApp MSG028

Date	Event	Source
01 Feb 2025	New GH¢200,000 invoice routed through construction company front (invoice_Feb2025.pdf)	WhatsApp MSG009–010 / Dropbox
03–04 Feb 2025	Police checkpoint on Accra-Kumasi road; instruction to reschedule cash run	WhatsApp MSG032–033
03 Feb 2025	Search: “police checkpoint accra kumasi highway”	Browser history
10 Feb 2025	Kumasi Stanbic GH¢55,000 collected by Kofi, confirmed “back room as usual”	WhatsApp MSG034–036
20 Feb 2025	14 falsified invoices confirmed ready (GH¢677,000), archived to falsified_invoices_Q1.zip	Email — RE_EXPORTS_2025_Dropbox.eml
23 Feb 2025	Search: “SWIFT wire transfer no trace ghana”	Browser history
28 Feb 2025	Q1 Summary to Boss: GH¢487,000 processed, USD 105,000 offshore, no alerts	PM-2025-0001
01 Mar 2025	Boss directs Q2 expansion: new Kumasi front, expand AMF channel	PM-2025-0002
07 Mar 2025	Cape Coast cash run, GH¢40,000, instructed to take coast road	WhatsApp MSG037–039
10 Mar 2025	Group chat: Q1 target confirmed (GH¢500,000), actual GH¢487,000; proceed to Q2	WhatsApp MSG040–046
(undated)	Searches relating to deleting WhatsApp messages and wiping browser history (anti-forensic attempt)	Browser history (URL IDs 21–22)
15 Mar 2025	Search and seizure executed at Delta Ventures Ltd premises; laptop seized	Case briefing

Task 21: Identify the Three Stages

The operation conforms closely to the classical three-stage money laundering model (Placement, Layering, Integration), with a fourth, cross-cutting layer of regulatory corruption protecting the entire process.

Stage 1 — Placement

Cash collected from multiple regional sources (Tarkwa: GH¢75,000; Kumasi: GH¢55,000 and GH¢120,000; Cape Coast: GH¢40,000) by Philip and Kofi was introduced into the financial system in structured amounts, each kept below the GH¢9,500 cap specified in Boss_directives_Q1.txt (itself derived from a browser search of the FIC reporting threshold), via Nancy through Accra Microfinance under reference REF-AML-2025-0041.

Stage 2 — Layering

Domestic funds were routed through three front companies — Delta Ventures Ltd, Gyimah Construction & Supplies, and West Coast Logistics Ltd — supported by 14 falsified invoices totalling GH¢677,000. These funds were then converted into international wire transfers disguised as legitimate trade transactions: USD 45,000 to Al Maktoum Investment Holdings (Dubai) described as “Consultancy Services”, and USD 60,000 to Limassol Trade & Advisory Ltd (Cyprus) described as “Software License Fees.”

Stage 3 — Integration

The offshore accounts in Dubai and Cyprus hold the laundered USD 105,000, reported to “Boss” as fully processed with “no alerts” (PM-2025-0001). These funds now present as legitimate consultancy and software-licensing revenue in jurisdictions disconnected from the originating cash, available for reinvestment — consistent with the directed Q2 expansion (new Kumasi front, expanded AMF channel).

Cross-Cutting Layer — Corruption & Obstruction

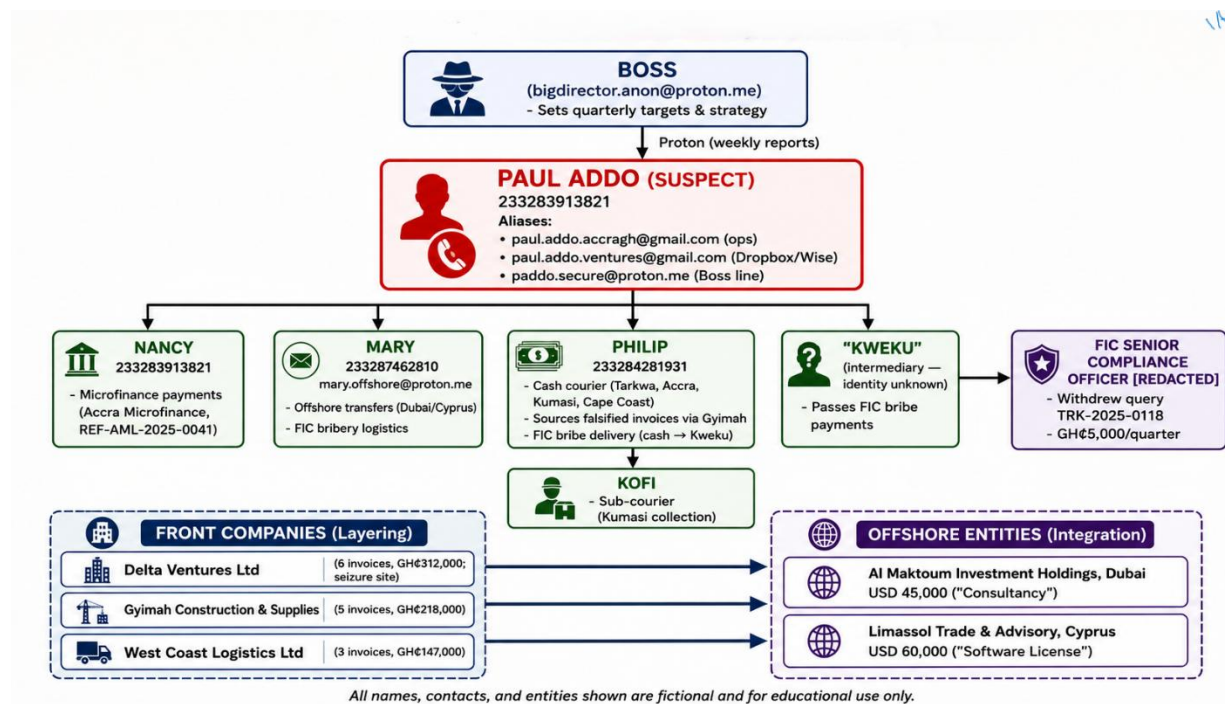
Running in parallel to all three stages, a quarterly GH¢5,000 cash payment to a Senior Compliance Officer at the FIC (delivered via Philip and the intermediary “Kweku”) directly resulted in the withdrawal of regulatory query TRK-2025-0118, shielding the operation from detection at a critical point in the placement/layering boundary.

Task 22: Deleted Evidence Recovery

Several deleted or attempted-to-be-deleted items were recovered:

10. /OLD/ledger_2024_Q3.xlsx (deleted, Dropbox journal id 13) — a prior quarter's laundering ledger, demonstrating that the scheme is recurring rather than isolated to Q1 2025.
11. /OLD/contacts_dirty.txt (deleted, Dropbox journal id 14) — an earlier version of the network's associate contact list.
12. /OLD/offshore_routing_2024.txt (deleted, Dropbox journal id 15) — 2024 offshore routing details, predating the Dubai/Cyprus routes used in Q1 2025, indicating route rotation as an anti-detection technique across operational cycles.
13. WhatsApp messages 1–55 remained fully recoverable in msgstore.db despite the explicit instruction in MSG005 to delete them — either the instruction was not followed, or deletion (if attempted) removed messages from the user interface without purging the underlying SQLite records.
14. The browser search “CCleaner delete browser history permanently” (Task 18) survived within the keyword_search_terms table despite apparently being made in an attempt to use such a tool to erase browsing history — the cleaning tool's own search query was not itself removed.
15. The physical receipt referenced in MSG030–031 was reportedly burned and cannot be recovered; however, its prior existence — and its link to Delta Ventures Ltd — is documented in the WhatsApp exchange and is relevant to chain-of-custody and provenance arguments concerning the seized premises.

Task 23: Suspect Network Diagram



The diagram above summarises the command structure, named individuals, front companies, and offshore destinations identified during this examination.

Command Structure

Tier	Entity	Identifiers	Function
1	"Boss" (concealed superior)	bigdirector.anon@proton.me	Sets quarterly targets and strategic direction; receives weekly/periodic reports
2	Paul Addo (suspect)	233283913821 (WhatsApp) / paul.addo.accragh@gmail.com / paul.addo.ventures@gmail.com / paddo.secure@proton.me	Central coordinator; communicates with Boss and all subordinates under multiple aliases
3	Nancy	233283913821 (WhatsApp)	Microfinance payment processing (Accra Microfinance)
3	Mary	233287462810 (WhatsApp) / mary.offshore@proton.me / mary.gyasi.finance@gmail.com	Offshore transfers (Dubai/Cyprus); FIC bribery logistics
3	Philip	233284281931 (WhatsApp)	Cash courier; sources falsified invoices; delivers FIC bribe to "Kweku"
4	Kofi	(not separately identified)	Sub-courier; Kumasi cash collection
4	"Kweku"	(unidentified — person of interest)	Intermediary passing cash bribes to FIC contact

Tier	Entity	Identifiers	Function
5	FIC Senior Compliance Officer	(redacted in source document)	Withdrew regulatory query TRK-2025-0118 in exchange for payment

Front Companies and Offshore Destinations

Front Company (Layering)	Invoices (Q1 2025)	Linked Offshore Destination (Integration)	Amount
Delta Ventures Ltd (seizure site)	6 invoices, GH¢312,000	Al Maktoum Investment Holdings LLC, Dubai, UAE	USD 45,000
Gyimah Construction & Supplies	5 invoices, GH¢218,000	Limassol Trade & Advisory Ltd, Cyprus	USD 60,000
West Coast Logistics Ltd	3 invoices, GH¢147,000	(unconfirmed — see Task 10, third transaction)	(pending)

Priority Follow-Up Actions

16. Cross-reference FIC query reference TRK-2025-0118 against the Financial Intelligence Centre's internal records; identify the Senior Compliance Officer concerned and the individual identified only as “Kweku.”
17. Issue a data preservation request / subpoena to Wise (TransferWise) for the account registered to paul.addo.ventures@gmail.com, identified as a previously undocumented transfer channel.
18. Verify the legitimacy and ownership of the domain ecowasbank-alerts.net as a banking notification source.
19. Forward account/IBAN details (AE070331234567890123456, Dubai; CY17002001280000001200527600, Cyprus) to the UAE Financial Intelligence Unit and Cyprus MOKAS for asset tracing and potential freeze action, including the unresolved third (IN_PROGRESS) transaction to Limassol Trade & Advisory Ltd.
20. Obtain and analyse the recovered 2024 ledger, contacts list, and offshore routing files from the /OLD/ Dropbox folder to establish the scope of a potential broader charge period predating Q1 2025.
21. Confirm hash verification of the original E01 image against acquisition-time values and append the acquisition log to this report (Task 1).
22. Obtain the full Autopsy file count summary, including allocated/unallocated breakdown, for inclusion in Task 3.

End of Report.